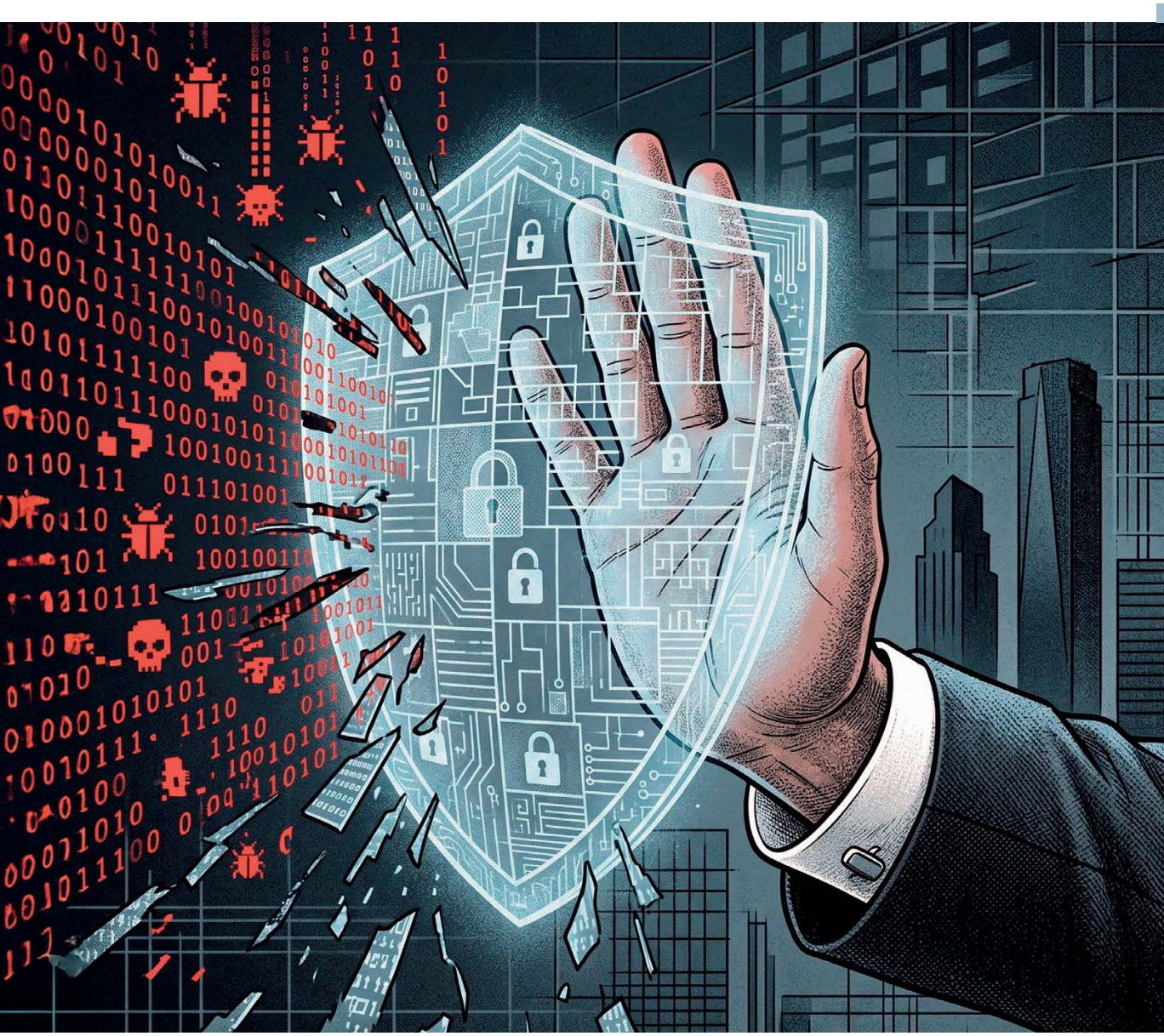


HDFC Bank's Lakshminarayanan says that banks need to start looking at security engineering models where AI reviews software for security vulnerability right when it is developed. Banks can also adopt micro-segmentation to isolate key functions, preventing simultaneous compromise, and use white-box cryptography (WBC), which combines encryption and obfuscation methods to embed secret keys in application code. "A fourth method is hardware-based key routing, where the keys are not in memory but secured in hardware," he adds.

Ultimately, the Mythos debate is about more than one AI model. It is about whether cybersecurity, finance and governance can keep pace with frontier technologies. Calls for self-regulation have struggled. In 2023, leading AI researchers and CEOs called for pausing more powerful AI systems. Technology moved on. That is why experts increasingly argue global frameworks may be unavoidable, whether through the United Nations, financial regulators or AI safety coalitions. "AI regulation should happen on a global scale," says Nandwani. But regulation alone will not be enough.

India has built one of the world's most ambitious digital financial ecosystems. Protecting it now requires treating cybersecurity not as compliance but as economic security itself. The Centre has moved early in recognising the threat. But safeguarding the trust millions have placed in these systems will require much more than advisories. It will require new doctrines, new defences and a new urgency. Because in the age of autonomous cyberAI, the next systemic shock may not begin with bad loans. It may begin with bad code. ■